

EAM310 • EAM DIAGNOSIS I • VUIM • SUMMER 2026

EXCEPT / NOT Question Pack

45 Negative-Format Questions — Your Documented Weak Spot

Prof. Daniel Schrier, D.O.M., L.Ac.

Week 3 • Pulse Diagnosis • Summer 2026

Jonathan Centeno • D.AcHM Candidate • VUIM 2026–2030

Why this pack exists

Negative-format questions — **EXCEPT, NOT, each of the following except** — fail differently from ordinary multiple choice. You have to hold four statements, verify each independently, and find the single false one. Knowing the material is not sufficient; you have to check all four rather than stopping at the first that looks right.

The three habits that fix it

1. **Circle the negative word** before you read the options. Most misses are people answering the positive version of the question.
2. **Mark each option T or F in the margin.** Don't hold four statements in your head — write the letters down.
3. **Expect exactly one F.** If you find two, you've misread one. If you find none, you've misread the stem.

1 45 Questions

1. All of the following are Nan Jing pairings EXCEPT:

- A. Left Cùn — Hand Shaoyin / HT
- B. Right Guān — Foot Taiyin / SP
- C. Left Chǐ — Hand Jueyin / PC
- D. Right Cùn — Hand Taiyin / LU

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

2. Each of the following is one of the five finger movements EXCEPT:

- A. Lifting
- B. Pressing
- C. Tapping
- D. Rolling

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

3. All of the following are components of a normal pulse EXCEPT:

- A. Width
- B. Tension
- C. Colour
- D. Shape

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

4. 胃神根 includes all of the following EXCEPT:

- A. Stomach-Qi
- B. Spirit
- C. Root
- D. Essence

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

5. All of the following are true of the Floating pulse EXCEPT:

- A. Felt distinctly at the superficial depth
- B. Force decreases slightly at depth
- C. It always indicates an Exterior pattern
- D. It may indicate Yin Deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

6. Each of the following supports an Exterior diagnosis EXCEPT:

- A. Simultaneous fever and aversion to cold
- B. Occipital stiffness
- C. Floating pulse
- D. Night sweats with five-palm heat

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

7. All of the following are seasonal pulses EXCEPT:

- A. Spring — Wiry
- B. Summer — Flooding
- C. Autumn — Slippery
- D. Winter — Stone

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

8. The Winter pulse spans all of the following EXCEPT:

- A. November
- B. December
- C. January
- D. March

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

9. All of the following indicate Cold EXCEPT:

- A. Slow
- B. Tight
- C. Deep with Slow
- D. Rapid

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

10. Each of the following is a Deficiency-side pulse EXCEPT:

- A. Empty
- B. Minute
- C. Weak/Frail
- D. Tight/Tense

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

11. All of the following are Excess-side pulses EXCEPT:

- A. Overflowing
- B. Full
- C. Tight
- D. Minute

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

12. Each of the following is felt at the superficial level EXCEPT:

- A. Floating
- B. Soggy
- C. Hollow
- D. Firm/Confined

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

13. All of the following are deep-level pulses EXCEPT:

- A. Deep/Submerged
- B. Hidden
- C. Firm/Confined
- D. Scattered

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

14. Each of the following is an irregular-rhythm pulse EXCEPT:

- A. Knotted
- B. Hasty
- C. Intermittent
- D. Hurried/Racing

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

15. All of the following are true of Intermittent EXCEPT:

- A. Pauses occur at regular intervals
- B. Indicates serious internal organ problems
- C. Can indicate a Heart problem in the Western sense
- D. Its pauses occur randomly

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

16. All of the following are true of Knotted EXCEPT:

- A. It is slow
- B. Missed beats are irregular
- C. The pulse resumes immediately after the missed beat
- D. It indicates severe Heat

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

17. Each of the following indicates Slippery EXCEPT:

- A. Phlegm
- B. Dampness
- C. Retention of food
- D. Blood Deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

18. All of the following are true of Choppy EXCEPT:

- A. Feels rough and jagged
- B. Classically 'scraping bamboo with a small knife'
- C. Indicates Blood Deficiency
- D. Feels smooth and rounded like a pearl

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

19. Each of the following is true of Huǎn (Slowed-Down/Moderate) EXCEPT:

- A. It beats four times per breath
- B. It is faster than the Slow pulse
- C. It is generally a healthy pulse
- D. It indicates interior Cold

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

20. All of the following are true of the Slow pulse EXCEPT:

- A. Fewer than three beats per breath
- B. Roughly 40–60 bpm
- C. Regular rhythm
- D. Roughly 90–140 bpm

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

21. Each of the following describes Wiry EXCEPT:

- A. Taut and long
- B. Maintains a straight line under the fingers
- C. Like a stretched instrument string
- D. Vibrates left and right like a twisted cord

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

22. All of the following indicate Wiry EXCEPT:

- A. Liver disharmony
- B. Pain
- C. Phlegm
- D. Hemorrhage

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

23. Each of the following is true of Hollow EXCEPT:

- A. Wide and soft on light touch
- B. Edges felt, centre obscure
- C. Classically a scallion stalk
- D. Rapid and forceful on light touch

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

24. All of the following are true of Leather EXCEPT:

- A. Large, thick and wide
- B. Hollow when pressed deeply
- C. Indicates severe Kidney-Essence Deficiency
- D. Soft and yielding at the surface

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

25. Each of the following indicates severe depletion EXCEPT:

- A. Scattered
- B. Minute
- C. Hasty with Fine and no strength
- D. Slowed-Down/Moderate

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

26. All of the following are true of Scattered EXCEPT:

- A. Forceless and slack on light touch
- B. Disappears under pressure
- C. Rate is hard to count
- D. Keeps its shape under pressure

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

27. Each of the following distinguishes Fine from Minute EXCEPT:

- A. Fine is distinct and clear
- B. Fine has uninterrupted rhythm under pressure
- C. Minute fades in and out
- D. Minute is wider than Fine

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

28. All of the following are true of Hidden EXCEPT:

- A. Cannot be felt on touching or seeking
- B. Requires very heavy pressure to the bone
- C. Indicates severe Yang Deficiency
- D. Is felt easily at the middle depth

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

29. Each of the following indicates Moving (動 Dòng) EXCEPT:

- A. Shock
- B. Anxiety and fright
- C. Pain
- D. Hemorrhage

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

30. All of the following are Floating combinations EXCEPT:

- A. Floating-Tight → Exterior Wind-Cold
- B. Floating-Rapid → Exterior Wind-Heat
- C. Floating-Slippery → Wind-Damp or Phlegm
- D. Floating-Wiry → interior Cold in the Liver channel

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

31. Each of the following is a Deep combination EXCEPT:

- A. Deep-Weak → Yang Deficiency
- B. Deep-Rapid → interior Heat
- C. Deep-Wiry → Blood Stasis or Chong Mai
- D. Deep-Floating → Exterior invasion

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

32. All of the following are Rapid combinations EXCEPT:

- A. Rapid-Full → Full Heat
- B. Rapid-Empty → Empty Heat
- C. Rapid-Wiry → Liver Fire
- D. Rapid-Slow → Damp-Cold

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

33. Each of the following is a Slippery combination EXCEPT:

- A. Slippery-Rapid → Damp-Heat or Phlegm-Heat
- B. Slippery-Slow → Damp-Cold or Cold-Phlegm
- C. Slippery-Big → Phlegm-Heat with Heat predominant
- D. Slippery-Choppy → Blood Stasis

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

34. All of the following are true of the three depths EXCEPT:

- A. Superficial is found with light contact
- B. Deep is found by pressing to the bone
- C. The middle is found by pressing to bone then releasing slowly
- D. The middle is the easiest of the three to find

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

35. Each of the following is Maciocia's reading of the depths EXCEPT:

- A. Superficial — Qi
- B. Middle — Blood
- C. Deep — Yin organs
- D. Deep — Wei Qi

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

36. All of the following are correct technique EXCEPT:

- A. Arm horizontal
- B. Arm not held above heart level
- C. Middle finger on Guān
- D. Keep the fingers completely still throughout

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

37. Each of the following moves the pulse independent of pathology EXCEPT:

- A. Recent exertion
- B. Room temperature
- C. Time of day
- D. The patient's surname

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

38. All of the following are true of counting rate EXCEPT:

- A. It is counted against the practitioner's breath
- B. The practitioner should breathe naturally
- C. There is a prescribed number of seconds per breath
- D. Patients may alter their breathing and shift the pulse

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

39. Each of the following describes a pulse block EXCEPT:

- A. One position full and tight
- B. The adjacent position relatively empty
- C. Treated by needling exit and entry points
- D. Always found at the Chǐ position bilaterally

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

40. All of the following are true of the Ying cycle EXCEPT:

- A. It begins with the Lung
- B. It runs through twelve channels
- C. It corresponds to the organ clock
- D. It runs LU → SP → ST → LI

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

41. Each of the following is a Shang Han Lun stage pulse EXCEPT:

- A. Tai Yang — Floating
- B. Yang Ming — Flooding and Long
- C. Shao Yang — Wiry
- D. Tai Yin — Hidden

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

42. All of the following climatic pairings are correct EXCEPT:

- A. Wind — Floating
- B. Cold — Tight
- C. Dampness — Soggy and Slippery
- D. Dryness — Slippery and wide

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

43. Each of the following is a red-flag finding EXCEPT:

- A. Intermittent
- B. Scattered
- C. Hasty with Fine and no strength
- D. Slowed-Down/Moderate

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

44. All of the following are true of a Flooding pulse in winter EXCEPT:

- A. It is out of season
- B. It suggests excess Yang
- C. Schrier linked it to a fatal outcome in a teaching case
- D. It should be treated as a normal seasonal variant

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

45. Each of the following would help confirm a Rapid pulse EXCEPT:

- A. Asking about thirst
- B. Asking about sensation of heat
- C. Looking for a red tongue with yellow coating
- D. Asking whether pain is relieved by pressure

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

46. All of the following are true of the Nan Jing EXCEPT:

- A. It standardised radial-artery pulse diagnosis
- B. It poses questions against the Su Wen
- C. It maps the twelve channels onto the positions
- D. It describes nine palpation regions across head, hands and feet

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

2 Answer Key

#	Ans	Why
1	C	PC sits at RIGHT Chǐ with TB. Left Chǐ is BL/KD.
2	C	The five are Lifting, Pressing, Searching, Pushing, Rolling.
3	C	Colour is a tongue parameter. The eight are Width, Depth, Rate, Rhythm, Strength, Length, Tension, Shape.
4	D	胃 Wèi, 神 Shén, 根 Gēn — Stomach-Qi, Spirit, Root.
5	C	The core trap. Floating also appears in Yin Deficiency.
6	D	Night sweats + five-palm heat point to Yin Deficiency.
7	C	Autumn is Hair-like/Floating 毛.
8	D	Nov 7 – Feb 3. March is Spring.
9	D	Rapid indicates Heat.
10	D	Tight is on the Excess side of Schrier's chart.
11	D	Minute is severe Qi and Blood deficiency.
12	D	Firm is deep, taut, long, wide, forceful.
13	D	Scattered is superficial and loses shape under pressure.
14	D	Racing is very rapid but REGULAR in rhythm.
15	D	Random pauses = Knotted or Hasty. Intermittent is patterned.
16	D	Severe Heat is Hasty. Knotted is Cold with Heart-Yang Deficiency.
17	D	Blood Deficiency is Choppy or Fine.
18	D	That describes Slippery.
19	D	Huǎn is the one qualitatively healthy pulse among the 28.
20	D	90–140 is Rapid.
21	D	Side-to-side vibration is Tight.
22	D	Hemorrhage is Hollow 芤.
23	D	Rapid and forceful at the surface describes Leather.
24	D	Leather is forceful at the surface — that's what separates it from Hollow.
25	D	Huǎn is healthy.
26	D	Losing shape is exactly what separates Scattered from Empty.

#	Ans	Why
27	D	Minute is not wider — both are narrow; Minute is also forceless.
28	D	If you find it at the middle depth it isn't Hidden.
29	D	Hemorrhage is Hollow.
30	D	Cold in the Liver channel is Deep-Wiry-Slow or Slow-Wiry.
31	D	Deep and Floating are opposite ends of the location axis.
32	D	A pulse cannot be both Rapid and Slow.
33	D	Slippery and Choppy are opposite textures.
34	D	Schrier is explicit that the middle is the hard one.
35	D	Wei Qi is superficial, not deep.
36	D	Fingers are still ONLY when counting rate.
37	D	The other three are all confounders Schrier names explicitly.
38	C	There is deliberately no prescribed second-count.
39	D	Blocks occur at channel junctions, not one fixed position.
40	D	Correct order is LU → LI → ST → SP.
41	D	Tai Yin is Moderate — neither fast nor slow.
42	D	Dryness gives Short, Hasty, Rough — dry things shrink.
43	D	Huǎn is healthy.
44	D	That is precisely the error the teaching case warns against.
45	D	Pressure response differentiates Deficiency from Excess, not Heat.
46	D	The nine regions come from the Su Wen — the older scheme.

3 Error Pattern Check

After you score it

Sort your misses into two piles. **Pile 1 — content:** you didn't know the fact. Route to the Study Guide. **Pile 2 — format:** you knew all four statements but picked the wrong one, or answered as if the stem were positive. If Pile 2 is bigger, the fix isn't more studying — it's the three habits above, applied every single time.

Q#	Missed because I didn't know it	Missed because of the format